

Chlamydoselachus anguineus

Frilled shark



Length 6½ ft
(Up to 2 m)
Weight Not recorded
Breeding Viviparous
Status Near threatened

Location E. Atlantic, S.W. Indian Ocean, W. and E. Pacific



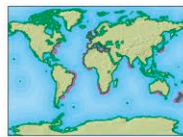
teeth with
3 sharp
points



This unusual, deep-water species looks more like an eel than a shark, with 6 frilled gill slits, a single small dorsal fin, and a much larger anal fin. It feeds on soft-bodied animals, such as squid and fish. Similar to some long-extinct species, it has no close living relatives.

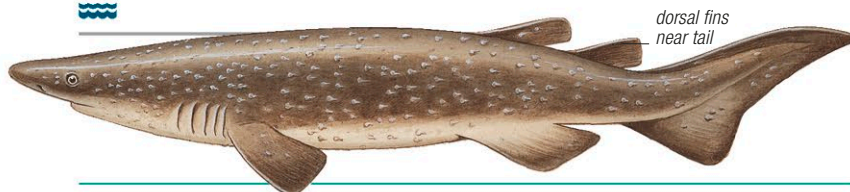
Echinorhinus brucus

Bramble shark



Length Up to 10 ft
(3.1 m)
Weight Over 490 lb
(220 kg)
Breeding Viviparous
Status Data deficient

Location N.E. Atlantic, W. Pacific, Mediterranean, Indian Ocean



The most interesting feature of this shark is the thorny denticles that cover its body. These have star-shaped bases and sharp tips, resembling bramble thorns. Large and slow-moving, the bramble shark spends most of its life foraging on or near the seabed. It feeds on other sharks, ratfishes, bony fishes, cephalopods, and the egg cases of sharks, skates, and rays. It may use its large pharynx and small mouth to create a vacuum effect to suck in prey.

dorsal fins
near tail

Oxynotus centrina

Angular roughshark

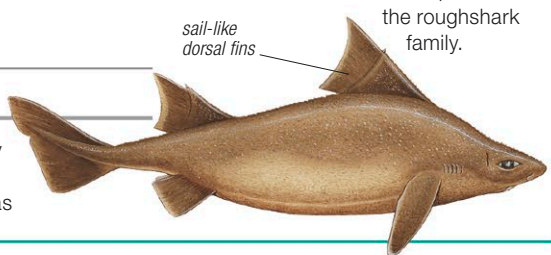


Length Up to 5 ft
(1.5 m)
Weight Not recorded
Breeding Viviparous
Status Vulnerable

Location E. Atlantic, Mediterranean



This shark has unusually high, sail-like dorsal fins with spiny tips. It also has



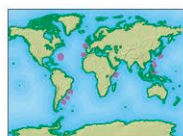
a compressed, triangular trunk and furrowed "lips" with lancetlike teeth in the upper jaw. There is a large spiracle behind the eye. The expanded body cavity and large, oily liver enable it to maintain buoyancy, allowing it to hover above the ocean floor in search of polychete worms and other invertebrates. It is one of 5 species in the roughshark family.

sail-like
dorsal fins

the roughshark
family.

Squaliolus laticaudus

Spined pygmy shark



Length Up to 10 in
(25 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Breeding Viviparous
Status Least concern

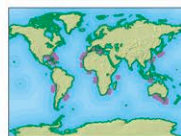
Location North Atlantic, W. South Atlantic, W. Indian Ocean, W. Pacific



One of the world's smallest sharks, this species only has a spine in front of the first dorsal fin. It has well-developed light-producing organs (photophores) on its belly and sides, but hardly any on the back, giving this shark a luminescent underside. The arrangement of these photophores is thought to eliminate shadows, making it harder for predators (such as swordfishes) to see it from below. The first known spined pygmy sharks were caught in 1908 off Japan, but no further specimens were seen until the 1960s.

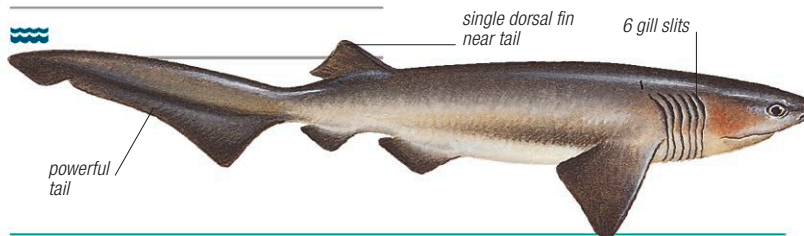
Hexanchus griseus

Bluntnose six-gill shark



Length 18 ft (5.5 m)
Weight 1,320 lb
(600 kg) or more
Breeding Viviparous
Status Near threatened

Location Tropical and temperate waters worldwide



single dorsal fin
near tail

6 gill slits

powerful
tail

This reclusive, primarily deep-water shark has a broad head and cylindrical body. It has 6 gill slits—unlike most other sharks, which have 5—and sharp, comblike teeth. The bluntnose six-gill feeds on rays, squid, bony fishes, and even seals. It also forages opportunistically for slow-moving animals on the seabed by positioning its body, head-down, at an angle of 45–60 degrees to the bottom. With its open mouth directly above the prey, it probably sucks in its food.

Squalus acanthias

Piked dogfish



Length 3¼ ft (1 m),
max 5¼ ft (1.6 m)
Weight 20 lb
(Over 9 kg)
Breeding Viviparous
Status Vulnerable

Location Worldwide outside the tropics



Also known as the spurdog, this small, bottom-dwelling shark lives in coastal waters, usually where the temperature is at or below 59° F (15° C). A slow-moving fish, it gets its name from the spines on the front of its dorsal fins, which can inflict painful wounds. It eats crustaceans, invertebrates, and bony fish, and often forms large, single-sex schools. Piked dogfishes give birth after a gestation period of nearly 2 years—a long time for any shark.

Etmopterus spinax

Velvet belly lantern shark



Length 18 in (45 cm),
maximum 23½ in
(60 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Breeding Viviparous
Status Least concern

Location E. Atlantic



This small, shoal-forming shark is one of more than 30 similar species. It feeds on invertebrates and small fishes. Tiny luminescent organs on its skin produce light, which help attract potential prey or other velvet belly lantern sharks, frighten predators, and disrupt shadows, making it less conspicuous.

FIRST MEAL



Like many sharks, young lantern sharks are born with an attached yolk sac. This provides them with food during their first few days at sea.

SPINED FINS

The velvet belly lantern shark has a sharp spine at the front of each dorsal fin; its second dorsal fin and fin spine are larger than the first.



spine